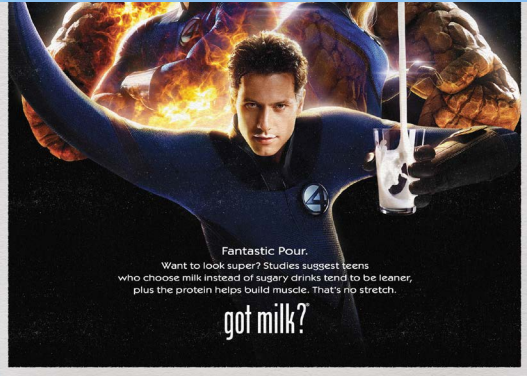
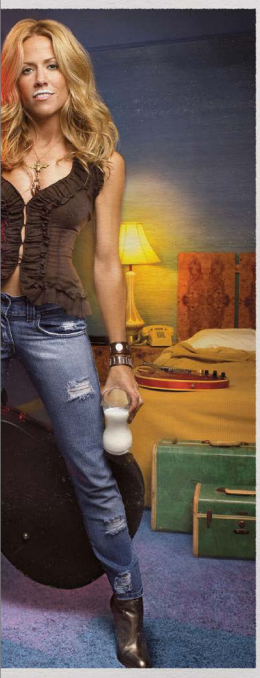






however savvy, couldn't compete against broader shifts in Americans' food and drink preferences. To be fair, Americans are still drinking plenty of milk—some 383 million gallons last July alone—But sales of bottled water, energy drinks, plant-based milks, and even kombucha are on the rise. In addition, we're eating out more and more. Concern over dairy cows' role in the climate crisis is growing. And as demographics shift, an ever larger percentage of Americans has trouble digesting lactose.

These days, instead of drinking milk, we're increasingly eating it—in the form of yogurt and cheese. Our cheese consumption has doubled since the early 1980s, and it's no coincidence: The dairy checkoffs that once poured big bucks into Got Milk? advertising have since reinvested in other dairy products.

As the New York Times reported, Dairy Management Inc., the national dairy checkoff program, paid Domino's Pizza to put 40% more cheese on its pies in 2010. A few years later, it partnered with Pizza Hut to create—and sell us on—stuffed-crust pizza. The move is arguably more controversial than the Got Milk? campaign, since it revolves around the USDA—the same government body that gave us dietary guidelines—promoting what is essentially fast food.

Looking back, Got Milk? seems almost noble in its "successful" failure. Compared to a slice of stuffed-crust pizza or a sugar-bomb energy drink, a good old-fashioned glass of milk seems like a pretty healthy choice.

got milk?®



